

MIDI notes to project markers

Turns every MIDI note into a project marker — one ruler lane per track, named after the track, coloured to match it. Write your cue rhythm as MIDI and get the markers for free.

A tab in [steelblue LD Tools](#) — or, as its own window, the shortcut you assigned during install, or [Actions](#) → [Show Action List](#)

WHAT IT IS FOR

Placing cues by ear, one marker at a time, is slow and never quite tight. Playing them in as MIDI is fast, quantises to the grid, and can be edited like music. This plugin takes that MIDI item and puts a marker at the start of every note.

Each track becomes one sequence: its markers go into their own ruler lane, carry the track's colour, and are named `Note(number) [Command]^Track^`. A kick track and a hat track are then two clean rows on the ruler and two separate cue lists on the console.

WHAT THE NAMES LOOK LIKE

The lane and the sequence are named after the track, with anything in brackets stripped — a track called **Kick (12)** gives lane and sequence `Kick`. The bracket stays on the track itself, because the number in it is the MA sequence number.

The cue number is the **rank of the pitch** within that track, counted upwards. Four different notes give cues 1 to 4; five hits of the same note all give cue 1, which is exactly right — that is one cue fired five times.

TRACK	NOTES	MARKERS
Kick (12)	C1 C2 C1 C3	C1(1) [Top]^Kick^ · C2(2) [Top]^Kick^ · C1(1) [Top]^Kick^ · C3(3) [Top]^Kick^

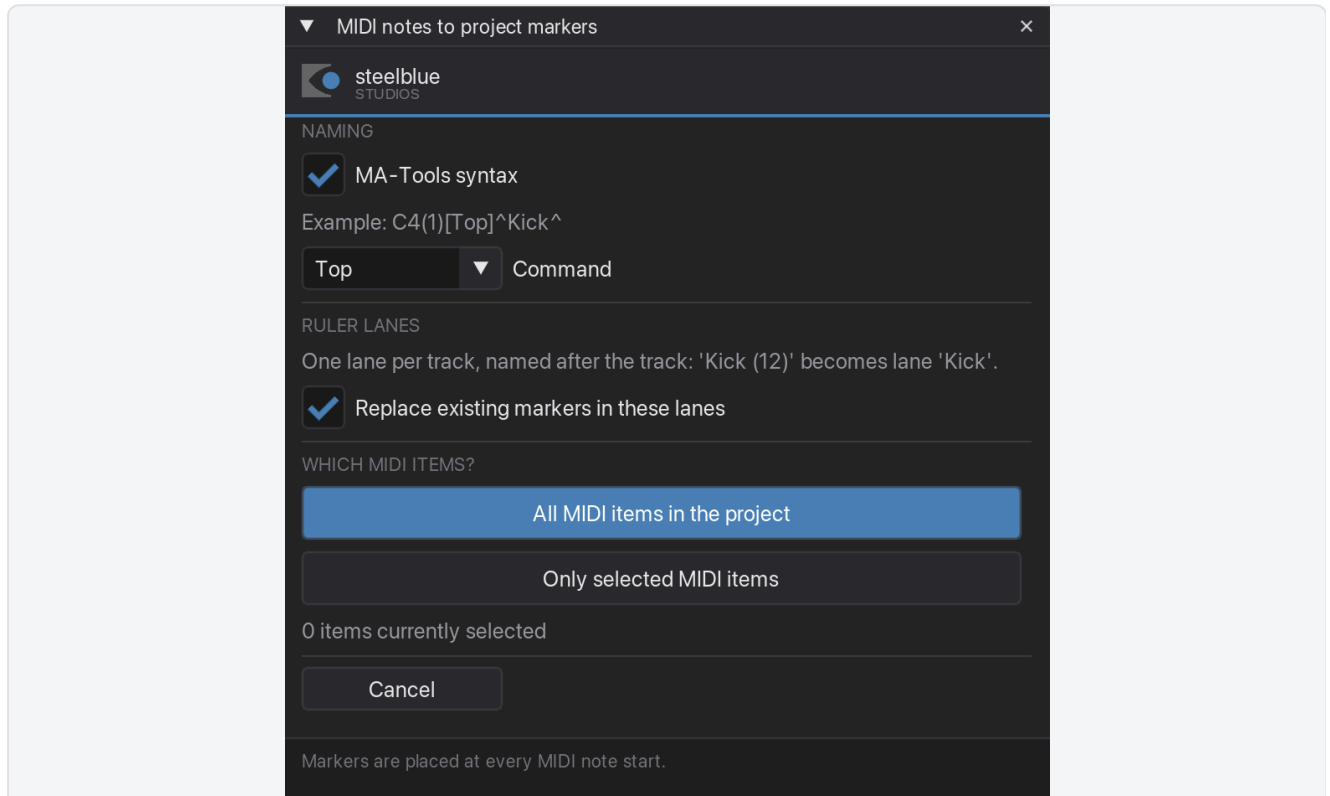
If the track has custom MIDI note names, those are used as the cue name instead of the pitch — but the rank still comes from the pitch.

1 Select the MIDI item

Click the item in the arrange view. If you want several, select them all — or skip this and use the whole project in the next step.

2 Open the tab, or start the plugin

Use the **MIDI notes to markers** tab, or run the plugin in its own window. It tells you how many items are currently selected, so you can check before committing.



The example line under the switch previews the naming, and the count at the bottom tells you what you are about to convert.

3 Choose the naming

MA-Tools syntax is on by default: a C4 on a track called *Kick* becomes **C4(1)** **[Top]^Kick^**, ready to trigger. Switch it off if you just want the plain note name — **C4** — for example when you intend to run *Rename selected markers* over them afterwards.

Command is a list: **Go**, **Top**, **Flash**. It is what goes in the square brackets, and the example line shows the result as you change it.

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Check the ruler lanes

Every track gets its own ruler lane, named after the track. The lane is created if it is not there yet, and it takes the track's colour, so the markers and the lane match.

Replace existing markers in these lanes is on, and it empties each lane before writing into it. Leave it on while you are still adjusting the MIDI — otherwise every run stacks another full set of markers on top of the last.

Two tracks with the same name are a problem, because both would produce `^Kick^` and the console could not tell the sequences apart. The plugin notices and asks before it writes anything. *Kick (12)* and *Kick (13)* count as the same name — the bracket is stripped.

Ruler lanes need **REAPER 7.72 or newer**. On an older REAPER the plugin says so in that spot and writes the names and colours without lanes; everything else is unchanged.

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Choose the scope

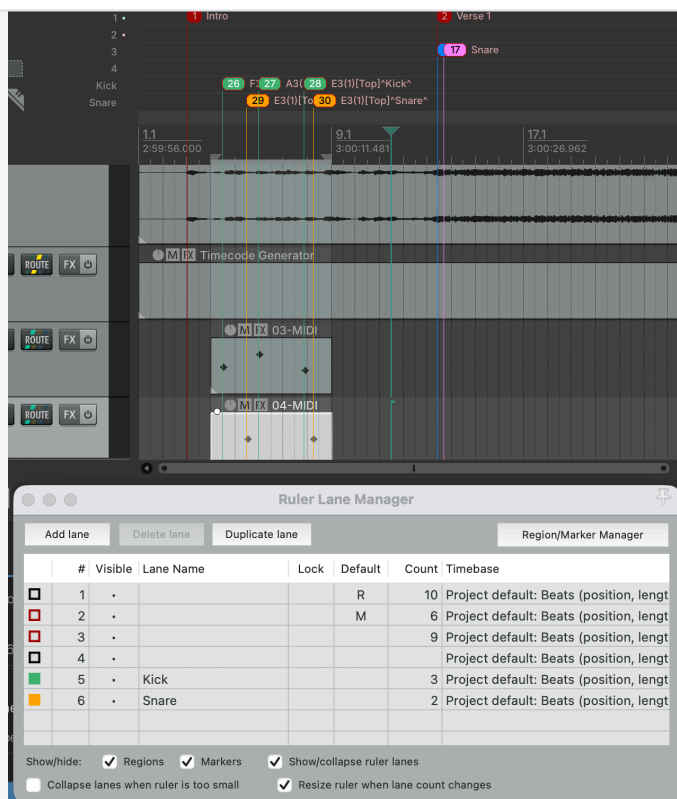
All MIDI items in the project

Every MIDI item, regardless of selection.

Only selected MIDI items

Just what you picked in step 1.

Either button starts the run straight away. A box afterwards says what was created.



One lane per track, each in the track's colour, names in MA-Tools syntax.

Looped items are followed

If the item loops its source, markers are created for every repetition you can see — across the item's full visible length, not just the first pass.

It warns before flooding your project

Above 2000 markers the plugin counts first and asks whether you really want them. A dense 16th-note pattern over a whole song adds up quickly, and undoing several thousand markers is no fun.

Markers land on note starts

Note length is ignored — only the start matters, which is what a cue trigger needs. So write your cue rhythm with short notes; it makes the MIDI easier to read without changing the result.

steelblue studios — MIDI notes to project
markers

Requires REAPER 7 · ruler lanes need 7.72 · tested on macOS and
Windows